Natalia Madrid

PhD Candidate in Economics, University of California San Diego
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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of California San Diego 2023–Present
Fields: Financial Economics and Environmental Economics.

Master of Arts in Economics, University of California San Diego 2025
Core courses: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics.

Master in Financial Management, Universidad de Concepción[1], Chile 2019
Thesis: Evaluation of the Impact of the 2008 Financial Crisis on Capital Structure of Companies in Latin America[2]. Advisor: Prof. Juan Gallegos.

B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2018
Thesis: Ex-post evaluation of Chile's R&D tax incentive law. Advisor: Prof. Cristian Mardones.

Research

Research Interests: Climate Finance, Banking, and Insurance

Working Papers

Transmission of Climate Risk in Corporate Loans *(with Max Yang)*

Abstract: *Local natural disasters are geographically concentrated, but corporate credit markets are integrated through national financial intermediaries, raising the question of whether natural disasters propagate through lending networks. In August 2017, Hurricane Harvey caused widespread damage to counties in Texas and Louisiana. Using U.S. syndicated loan data, we compare lenders with different pre-storm portfolio concentration in the damaged counties lending to the same unaffected borrower. On the intensive margin, lenders one standard deviation more exposed to Harvey cut credit to unaffected borrowers by 4.8 percent of loan volume, with no adjustment in spreads or maturities. The effect is also not explained by distance to the storm, and it is unchanged among borrowers located more than 1,000 miles from the impact zone. Instead, the borrower's hurricane risk predicts the credit supply contraction, which we measure using the historical frequency of hurricanes at the borrower's location from NOAA data. Credit falls for borrowers in hurricane-prone counties, and exposed lenders move about two percentage points of their portfolios out of hurricane-risky counties. On the extensive margin, the most exposed lenders are more likely to end lending relationships with hurricane-risky borrowers. The evidence is consistent with a highly visible disaster leading exposed lenders to move away from climate-risky borrowers throughout their portfolios, a reallocation of climate risk in quantities.*

Work in Progress

Financial Frictions and Insurance Sector Resilience to Natural Disasters *(with Mariela Dal-Borgo)*

Mortgage Markets in the Aftermath of a Hurricane *(with Bartolo Villar-Hernández)*

Published Articles

Mardones, C. and Madrid Becerra, N. (2020). "Ex-post evaluation of the R&D tax incentive law in Chile." *Academia Revista Latinoamericana de Administración*, 33(3/4), 337–359. doi.org/10.1108/ARLA-03-2019-0092

[1]The Universidad de Concepción ranks as the 3rd best university in Chile according to the Academic Ranking of World Universities (ARWU) and is ranked 11th in Latin America by the QS World University Rankings. I graduated with the highest distinction in both undergraduate and graduate studies, ranking in the top 5% of the class.

[2]Presented at the 10th INEKA (Innovation, Entrepreneurship and Knowledge Academy) Conference, Verona, Italy, 2019, by Prof. Juan Gallegos on behalf of both authors.

Conference, Workshops, and Summer Schools

Conference and Seminar Presentations

NBER Climate and Nature Finance Conference (poster), Norway	2026
Finance Brown Bag Seminar, Rady School of Management, UCSD	2026
Climate Conference, Climate Action Lab, UCSD	2026
Internal Macroeconomics Seminar, Economics Department, UCSD	2025
Internal Environmental Economics Seminar, Economics Department, UCSD	2025
Chilean Network of Innovation Researchers Conference, Chile	2021

Workshops and Summer Schools

CSWEP Mentoring Workshop (forthcoming), American Economic Association	2026
PhD Workshop on Climate Finance (forthcoming), National Bureau of Economic Research	2026
Summer School in Dynamic Structural Econometrics, University of Michigan	2026
Summer School in Environmental Economics, University of California Berkeley	2025

Research Experience

Summer Research Intern, Banco de México 2026
Summer Research Fellow at the General Directorate of Financial Stability, conducting research on financial stability topics. Supervisors: Calixto Lopez and Adrian Pardo.

Summer Graduate Research Fellow, University of California San Diego 2024
Independent summer research fellowship. Faculty advisor: Prof. Judson Boomhower.

Research Assistant, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2018
Supported research under Profs. Cristian Mardones and Pablo Catalán at the Center for the Study of Innovation Systems; co-authored a published paper on Chile's R&D tax incentive law; and contributed evidence-based insights on innovation policy for Chile's national economic development agency.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, University of California San Diego 2024–Present
- Graduate: Finance & Valuation in Corporate Finance (Prof. William Mullins) Winter 2025–26
- Graduate: Real Estate Finance (Prof. Carlos Avenancio-Leon) Spring 2026
- Undergraduate: Principles of Economics (Prof. Yinlin Dai, Prof. Judson Boomhower) Fall 2025–26
- Undergraduate: Econometrics (Prof. Graham Elliot, Prof. Yinlin Dai) Fall 2024–25

Lecturer, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2019–2020
Instructor for 120 students; designed course materials and supervised teaching assistants.
- Undergraduate: Accounting and Industrial Costs First Semester
- Undergraduate: Economic Engineering Second Semester

Relevant Professional Experience

Quality Management Specialist, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2020–2022
Redesigned quality management systems for training programs using Power BI; developed evaluation models for higher education quality practices (UCO 19101 Project).

Consulting Analyst, CameronPartners Innovation Consultants, Chile 2019–2020
Provided financial management advisory to 10+ SMEs; contributed to an acceleration program for 20 SMEs under CORFO's Innovation Fund for Competitiveness (FIC).

Honors, Scholarships, and Grants

Richard Libby Research Award ($10,000), Rady School of Management, UCSD 2026
Travel Grant ($800), Economics Department, UC San Diego 2026
Travel Grant ($500), Alfred P. Sloan Foundation, UC Berkeley 2025
Summer Research Scholarship ($3,500), University of California San Diego 2024
Regents Fellowship ($27,000), University of California San Diego 2023
Fulbright Doctorate Scholarship ($100,000), Fulbright Commission–ANID, Chile 2020
Outstanding Woman Engineer Award, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2019
Merit Scholarship for a Master degree ($3,000), Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2016
Bicentennial Scholarship for Bachelor degree ($15,000), Ministry of Education, Chile 2012

Community Service and Leadership

Fulbright Board Member, San Diego Fulbright Chapter 2026–Present
Summer Reading Group Coordinator, Climate Change Economics, UCSD 2025
Educational Mentor, Powerful Women Program, WoomUp, Chile 2020
Student Council Member, Industrial Engineering Student Association, UDEC 2016

Academic and Professional Memberships

American Finance Association · Association of Environmental and Resource Economists
Fulbright Association · Econometric Society · Southern Economic Association

Languages, Skills and Citizenship

Languages: English (C1), Spanish (native)
Computing: Python, STATA, C++, MySQL, LaTeX, HTML/CSS, Microsoft Office
Citizenship: Chile

References

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